HTTP/1.1 200 OK

Date: Fri, 04 Feb 2000 21:03:38 GMT

Server: Apache/1.3.9 (UNIX) PHP/4.0b3

Set-Cookie: name=xyz; expires=Friday, 04-Feb-07 22:03:38 GMT;

path=/; domain=tutorialspoint.com

Connection: close

Content-Type: text/html

As you can see, the Set-Cookie header contains a name value pair, a GMT date, a path and a domain. The name and value will be URL encoded. The expires field is an instruction to the browser to "forget" the cookie after the given time and date.

Keyword

HTTP is an application protocol for distributed, collaborative, and hypermedia information systems.

If the browser is configured to store cookies, it will then keep this information until the expiry date. If the user points the browser at any page that matches the path and domain of the cookie, it will resend the cookie to the server. The browser's headers might look something like this −

GET / HTTP/1.0

Connection: Keep-Alive

User-Agent: Mozilla/4.6 (X11; I; Linux 2.2.6-15apmac ppc)

Host: zink.demon.co.uk:1126

Accept: image/gif, */*

Accept-Encoding: gzip

Accept-Language: en

Accept-Charset: iso-8859-1, *, utf-8

Cookie: name=xyz

A PHP script will then have access to the cookie in the environmental variables $_COOKIE or $HTTP_COOKIE_VARS [] which holds all cookie names and values. Above cookie can be accessed using $HTTP_COOKIE_VARS["name"].

Setting Cookies with PHP

PHP provided setcookie() function to set a cookie. This function requires up to six arguments and should be called before <html> tag. For each cookie this function has to be called separately.